LESSON 9

The Surprise

From Haydn's "Surprise" Symphony (1792): a quiet tune, played again even quieter… then a loud chord to wake everyone up.
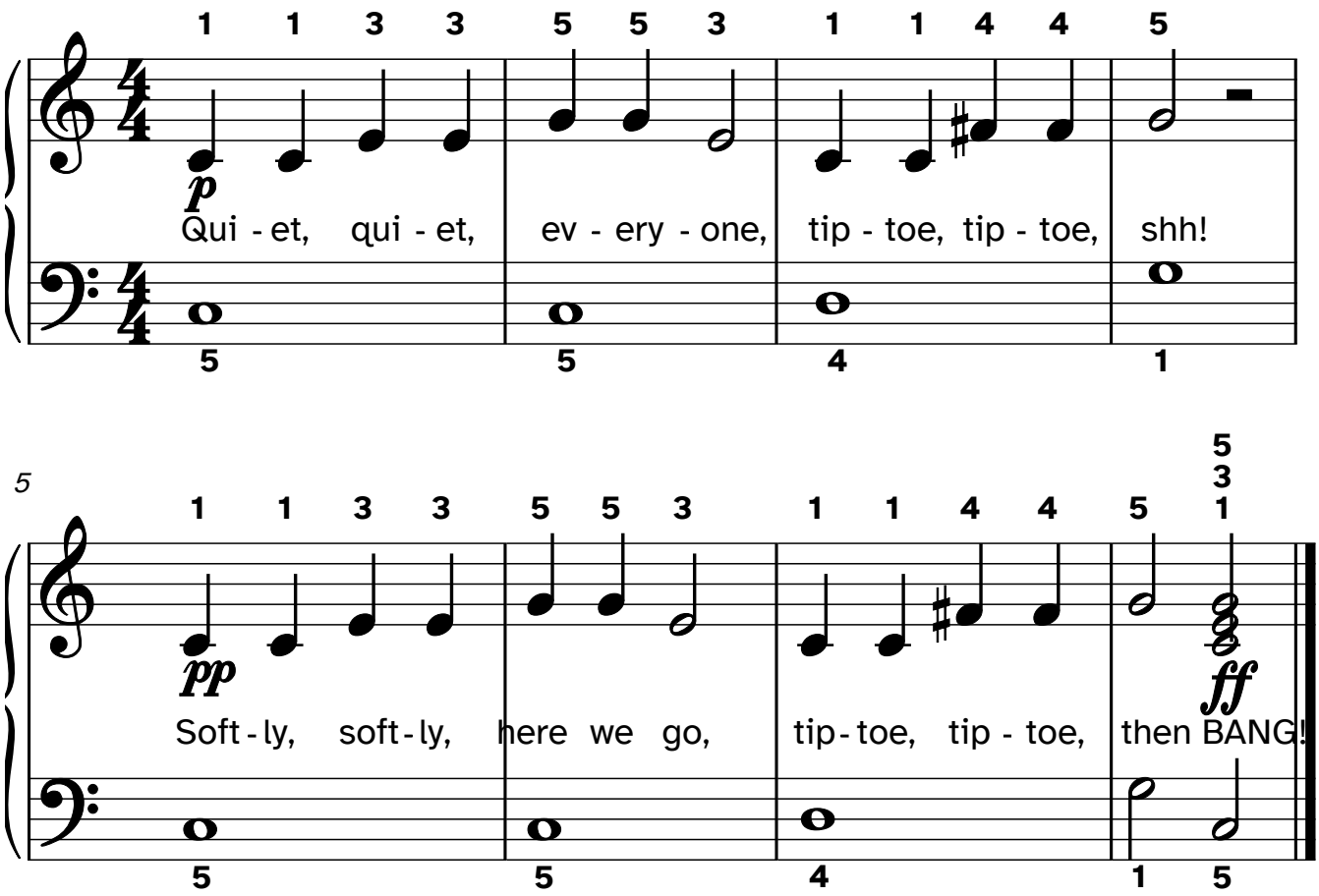
IN THIS SONG **F sharp: a black key** **p and f: soft and loud** **a new root, D**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing. Sing it soft, then very soft… then BANG! Then play it with both hands.

Right hand: C position; 4 moves up to the black key, F♯. **Left hand:** the roots C (5), D (4), G (thumb).



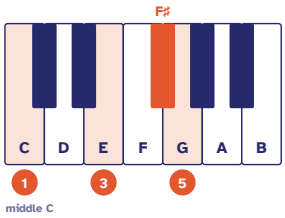
THE WOW MOMENT
☆ **The surprise:** Haydn wrote it for listeners who dozed off. Play the second half as softly as a whisper… then BANG, with both hands!

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Played the soft and the very soft** ☐ **Made the BANG**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

RIGHT HAND · C POSITION, 4 ON F♯



NEW IN THIS SONG

F♯ (F sharp): the black key just right of F, F's best friend. **p** soft, **pp** very soft, **f** loud, **ff** very loud. **New root D:** the left hand's 4.

THE RHYTHM

Say it in time, then clap and count: clap on coral, hold on grey, lift on a rest.

THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.

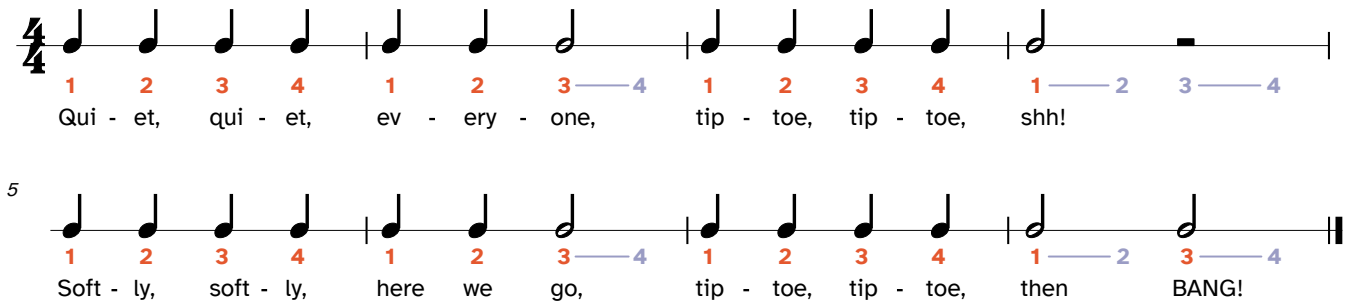
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

crotchet: walk — 1 beat ●

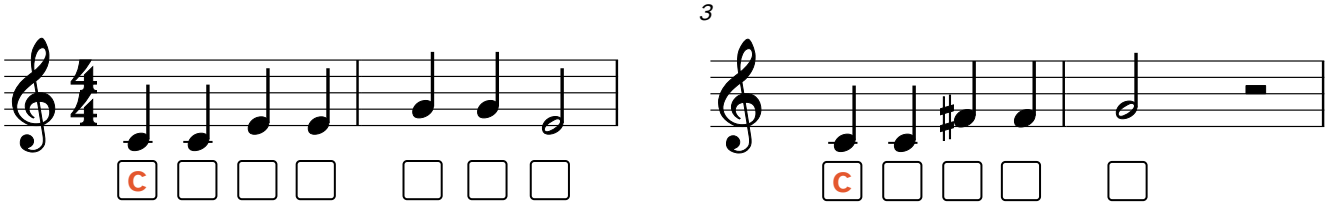
crotchet rest: knock — 1 beat ●

minim: hold — 2 beats ●●



THE NOTES

Write each letter. ♯ in front: the black key just to the right. Write F♯.



SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays F for F♯, or loud for soft. Put up your hand when you hear it.

☐ **Said it in time** ☐ **Clapped it** ☐ **Wrote the letters** ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

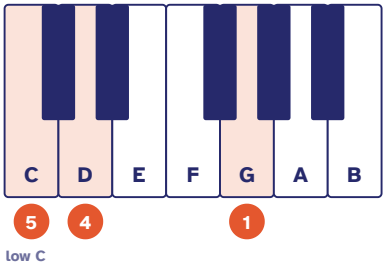
3 The roots

A new root today, D, under the bars that lean on F♯. The hand still never moves.

MEET THE ROOTS

Three roots now, all under the left hand: C is 5, D is 4, G is the thumb.

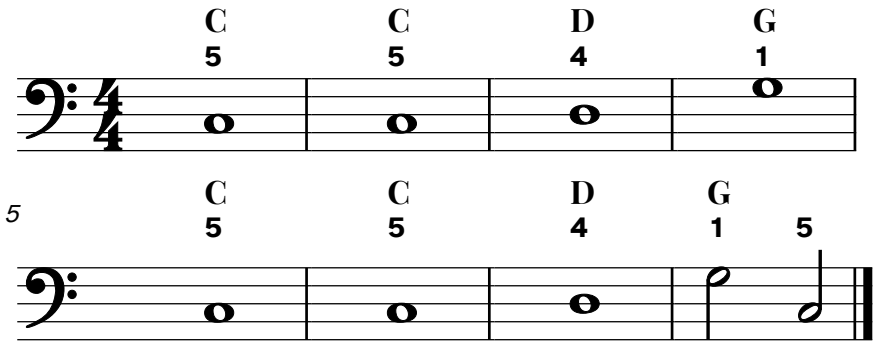
LEFT HAND · AN OCTAVE BELOW MIDDLE C



C: 5.
D: 4. New.
G: 1, the thumb.

THE ROOTS, WITH THEIR NAMES

The left hand's part on its own. In the last bar: G, then C for the BANG.



PLAY FROM THE NAMES

Only the names now. Play each bar's root and hold it while the band plays the tune.

C	C	D	G
C	C	D	G C

4 · CHECK

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	Slowly	Steady	With the band	Fast
From the notes				
From the names				
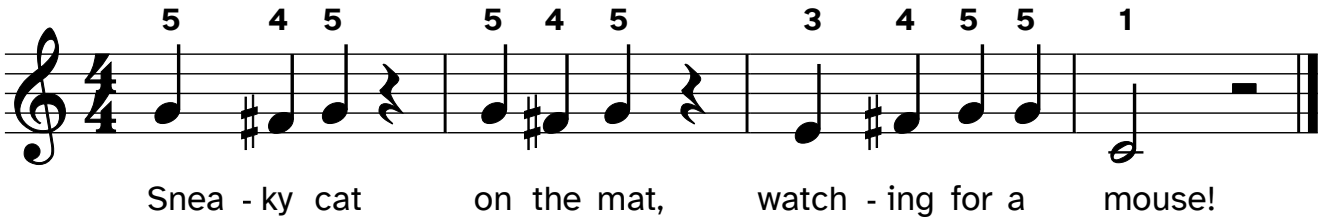
TEACHER ☐ **Pass** ☐ **Not yet**

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

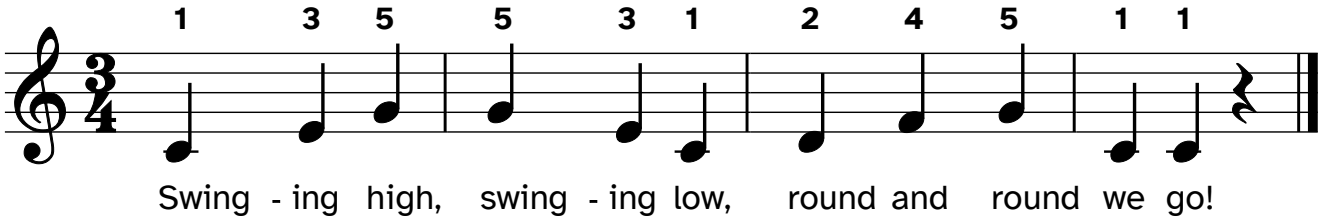
SNEAKY CAT

Tiptoe music: 4 slides onto the black key and back, like a cat creeping.



SWING SONG

A peek at Lesson 10: three beats in a bar. Lean on beat 1, like a swing.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **The other way round: very soft first, then soft**
- ☐ **Two bangs at the end**
- ☐ **Up high: an octave higher**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand alone, soft and very soft
3. Both hands, with the band
4. Your choice: a tune from this page

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Sneaky Cat** ☐ **Played Swing Song**